

# Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,  
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—  
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

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The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff and a bass line on a bass clef staff. The key signature has one flat (B-flat) and the time signature is 12/8. The melody is characterized by a steady eighth-note pulse. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm in the first system; Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm in the second system; F, C, Dm, A, Dm, C, Dm, C, F in the third system; and Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm in the fourth system. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three lines of text.

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,  
2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;  
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros - per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

in the strife of truth with false - hood, for the good or e - vil side;  
they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.  
though her por - tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch - ed crust,  
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp - fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,  
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side

ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp - 'rous to be just;  
nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.  
till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de - nied.